REPO RADAR

Mister Download Manager: setup guide

Free, open source download manager written in Rust, by Ahmed Nefzaoui. License: GPL-3.0-or-later.

Repository: github.com/anefzaoui/misterdownloadmanager

What it does

- Splits one download into pieces and fetches them over several connections at once (8 by default, 1 to 128).
- Pauses and resumes: an interrupted download continues from where it stopped (a `.mdm.json` state file sits next to it).
- Checks the finished file against a hash you give it (MD5, SHA-1, SHA-256, SHA-512, CRC32).
- Windows, macOS and Linux, with a window app, browser extensions and a command line.

Our test (12 Nov 2026, 4-core cloud VM, one run each)

- File: Debian 13.7.0 netinst ISO, 756 MB.
- curl, one connection: 38.5 s. Mister Download Manager, 8 connections: 9.1 s.
- Download stopped at 2.2 %, then `resume`: finished in 6.5 s.
- All three files matched Debian's official SHA-256.
- Building from source took 10 min 13 s. Your speed depends on your line and the server.

Install

1. Windows: take the `...-setup.exe` from the releases page, or run `winget install AhmedNefzaoui.MisterDownloadManager`.

2. Linux: `.deb` (Ubuntu, Debian, Mint), `.rpm` (Fedora, openSUSE) or `.AppImage` from the same releases page.
3. macOS: the macOS file from the releases page.
4. Early versions are not code-signed yet: your system may warn you the first time. Only download from the official repository.

Build it from source (what we did)

1. Install Rust (stable, recent: the project asks for 1.98 or newer), plus `cmake` and `libclang`.
2. `git clone https://github.com/anefzaoui/misterdownloadmanager`
3. `cd misterdownloadmanager`
4. `cargo build --release -p mdm-app -p mdm-cli`
5. The programs land in `target/release/`.

3 ways to use it

1. Big file, faster: `misterdownloadmanager-cli get <url> -o ~/Downloads`
2. Verified download: `misterdownloadmanager-cli get <url> --checksum sha256:<hash from the site>`
3. Bad connection: press Ctrl+C to pause, then `misterdownloadmanager-cli resume "<file>.mdm.json"`

Good to know

- More connections help when the server limits speed per connection. If your own internet line is the limit, the gain is small.
- Some servers allow few connections: lower it with `-c 2`.
- Download only files you have the right to download.

Sources: the project's README, Cargo.toml and command-line help; Debian SHA256SUMS; our sandbox test.

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